FIRE SAFETY INSPECTION REPORT

TARATEX FASHION LTD.

6/1, NAIMUDDIN MOLLAH ROAD, NORTH AUGH PARA, TONGI GAZIPUR

OTHER FACTORIES: NONE



ACCORD
on Fire and Building Safety in Bangladesh

August 6, 2014

SUMMARY

Taratex Fashion Ltd. was surveyed for fire safety on 06-08-2014 by Hughes Associates, Inc. This summary identifies the major deficiencies that were identified during the inspection.

The purpose of this survey was to identify significant fire safety issues and to provide recommendations for remediation based on applicable standards specified by the Accord. The scope of this initial fire safety inspection was limited to the review and identification of major fire safety issues. The inspection did not include identification of minor deficiencies, which will be further addressed as part of follow-up inspections.

Table 1 summarizes the major fire safety issues identified during the inspection. Recommendations have been provided to address each issue.

An implementation schedule shall be developed by the factory to remediate each of the findings. The specific timing of improvements, including any requested extensions due to design / installation constraints, shall be submitted to the Accord for approval.

Table 1. Findings And Recommendations

No.	Category	Finding	Recommendation	Remediation Timeframe
F-1	Fire Rated Construction	The elevator shaft was not separated by fire-rated construction on all floors.	Seal the elevator shaft on all floors.	Within 1 month







F-2	Fire Rated Construction	The boiler, generator and transformer rooms were not separated by fire-rated construction due to openings, non-rated doors and penetrations. The generator room was not separated from the sub station (transformer room).	Separate the boiler, generator and transformer rooms by a minimum 2-hr fire-rated construction. Seal and/or protected all openings to maintain the required fire separations	Within 3 months







F-3	Fire Rated Construction	Rooms used for combustible storage are not separated by fire-rated construction. Specifically the first floor finished goods storage room and the ground floor accessory store, wastage warehouse and warehouse. Access to the first floor northeast exit stair passes through finished goods storage room.	Provide dedicated storage rooms separated by minimum 1-hr fire-rated construction. Provide a 1-hr fire rated exit passageway leading to the first floor northeast exit stair. The ground floor warehouse storage room is located within the the accessory store, thus separation of the accessory store is only required.	Within 3 months







F-4	Fire Rated Construction	Areas used for combustible storage, open to the factory floor, are not separated by fire-rated construction. Specifically areas on the first, second and third floors.	Provide dedicated storage rooms separated by minimum 1-hr fire-rated construction. Where separate storage rooms are not feasible, provide defined storage areas and limit the storage arrangement as follows: - Maximum height of 2.4m and maximum area of 23m2 - If sprinkler protected: maximum height of 3.66m and maximum area of 93m2 Separate areas of unenclosed combustible storage by a minimum clear distance of 3m.	Within 3 months







F-5	Fire Rated Construction	The exit stairs are not separated from work areas and other spaces on each floor by fire-rated construction.	Provide minimum 1.5-hr fire rated doors and seal all unprotected openings to separate the exit stairs from work areas and other building spaces on all floor levels. Ensure that the fire doors are self-closing and positive latching and that they are provided with fire exit (panic) hardware where serving production floors. If fire doors are required to be held open for functional reasons, provide automatic-closing devices tied to the fire alarm system.	Within 3 months







F-6	Fire Rated Construction	Unsealed penetrations (hydrant piping) are located in the fire-rated floor/ceiling assemblies on many of the floors.	Seal all penetrations and openings in floor/ceiling assemblies to maintain the fire separation.	Within 3 months







F-7	Egress	Egress doors and gates with locking features are provided at building exits, exit stairs, along egress routes and at exit discharge. All gates and doors were open and unlocked during the inspection.	Remove locking features from all egress doors and gates. If locks are required for security reasons, utilize special door locking features complying with NFPA 101.	Immediate





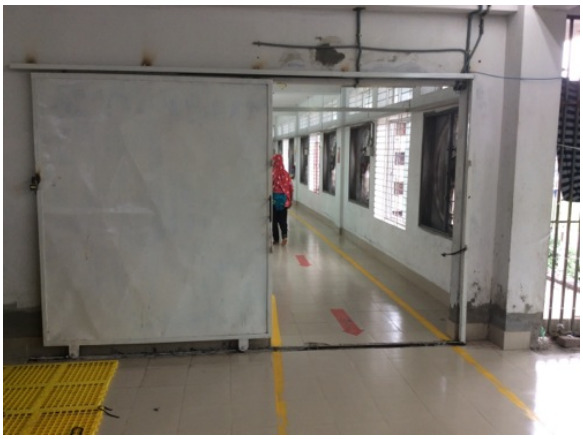


F-8	Egress	Storage was located in each exit stair on various floors.	Remove all storage from exit stairs and egress paths.	Immediate



F-9	Egress	Collapsible gates and sliding doors are provided at building exits, exit stairs, along egress routes and at exit discharge.	Replace all gates and sliding doors along the means of egress with side-hinged, swinging egress doors. If locks are required for security reasons, utilize special door locking features complying with NFPA 101.	Within 1 month







F-10	Egress	The egress doors through the main sliding doors to the main road do not swing in the direction of egress travel.	Modify the egress doors to swing in the direction of egress travel.	Within 3 months





F-11	Egress	The southwest and west exit stairs discharge inside the building to the ground floor. The west exit stairs discharge to a car port and the southwest exit stairs discharge to the interior of the building.	Modify the southwest exit stair to discharge directly outside. Provide a 2-hr fire-rated exit passageway leading directly outside for the west exit stair (vestibules to separate any storage areas). Alternately, provide sprinkler protection for discharge floor in accordance with NFPA 13.	Within 6 months





F-12	Fire Protection	The fire alarm system is antiquated, not a listed system, and does not provide alarm and notification features consistent with acceptable standards.	Replace the fire alarm system with a new, listed addressable fire alarm system in accordance with NFPA 72.	Design within 4 months, install within 9 months







F-13	Fire Protection	The fifth floor was under construction during the inspection and thus not provided with emergency lighting, exit signs, emergency evacuation plans, fire hoses, fire alarm system components, a fire detection system, portable fire extinguishers and manual fire fighting equipment.	Before occupying the fifth floor with factory operations, provide each fire and life safety system/component in accordance with its respective standard.	Immediate
F-14	Fire Protection	Inspection, testing, and maintenance of the fire alarm system is not in accordance with NFPA 72.	Inspect, test and maintain the fire alarm system, and keep written records on-site, in accordance with NFPA 72.	Within 3 months
F-15	Fire Protection	Based off observations, the existing smoke detectors tied to the fire alarm were not adequately provided.	Based on ceiling configuration, provide additional detectors where needed, and space them in accordance with NFPA 72.	Within 3 months



F-16	Egress Lighting	Some battery powered emergency lighting units did not function in test mode (burned out, broken, etc.).	Reguarly test the emergency lighting system on each floor and replace/repair lights as needed.	Within 1 month



F-17	Egress Lighting	Inspection, testing, and maintenance for the emergency lighting system was not in accordance with The ACCORD standard.	Inspect, test and maintain the emergency lighting system in accordance with The ACCORD standard. Keep written records on-site.	Within 3 months
F-18	Egress Lighting	Based on the number and location of emergency lights observed, adequate illumination levels are not anticipated along all egress routes.	Test the emergency lighting system on each floor and provide additional emergency fixtures to provide adequate illumination along the means of egress. Provide a minimum illumination of 10 lux at the floor level within exit stairs and exit discharge paths and minimum 2.5 lux along exit access aisles.	Within 3 months